

NEOLITHIC & CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES

FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL → DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL → TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN → INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP → ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE → CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE Pending user review source generation g11 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA prior artefacts unchanged exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 FOOD PRODUCTION: A REGIONAL MOSAIC

FOOD PRODUCTION A REGIONAL MOSAIC MIXED FARMING SURPLUS/STORAGE WILD USE SELECTIVE TENDING HERITABLE CHANGE CROPS+HERDS DELAYED NO UNIVERSAL PACKAGE POLISHED STONE, POTTERY, HERDING AND CROPS APPEAR IN VARIED

NEOLITHIC CHANGES LIFEWAYS; CHALCOLITHIC ADDS COPPER WITHIN STONE-USING ECONOMIES.

FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable

No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.

Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable change crops+herds delayed consumption
- No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.
- FORAGING → MANAGEMENT → DOMESTICATION → MIXED FARMING → SURPLUS/STORAGE wild use selective tending heritable change crops+herds delayed consumption

IMPACT / LIMIT

- No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.
- Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

01

STAGE 01 DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE

DOMESTICATION EVIDENCE AND CAUSAL DEBATE SEED-SIZE/RACHIS CHANGE + WEED ECOLOGY + STORAGE + GRINDING MORPHOLOGY + AGE/SEX KILL PROFILE + CORRALS/DUNG + HERD RISK BUFFERING SOCIAL COMPETITION NICHE CONSTRUCTION

DOMESTICATION NEEDS CONVERGING BIOLOGICAL AND CONTEXTUAL EVIDENCE. RICE PRESENCE ALONE DOES NOT PROVE CULTIVATION; SECURE DATE

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- PLANTS: seed-size/rachis change + weed ecology + storage + grinding tools
- ANIMALS: morphology + age/sex kill profile + corrals/dung + herd demography
- CAUSES: climate

METHOD / DEBATE

- risk buffering
- social competition
- niche construction

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.
- Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

02

STAGE 02 TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN

TECHNOLOGY-SETTLEMENT-SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE CHAIN POLISHED STONE + MICROLITHS + BONE TOOLS + POTTERY LONGER RESIDENCE ACCUMULATED PROPERTY CRAFT/EXCHANGE GROWTH DISEASE, LABOUR LOAD AND DIETARY

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage →

accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence →
- accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence →
- accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not

DEBATE / LEGACY

- polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence →
- accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery cultivation/herding → houses → storage → longer residence → accumulated property craft/exchange growth disease, labour load and dietary risk household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

03

STAGE 03 INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP

INDIAN NEOLITHIC REGIONAL MAP LONG FARMING/HERDING SEQUENCE BEFORE HARAPPAN URBANISM BURZAHOM, GUFKRAL PIT DWELLINGS, BONE TOOLS, AGRO-PASTORALISM VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA KOLDIHW, MAHAGARA, LAHURADEWA RICE/DATE CAUTIONS

SHOULDERED CELTS AND REGIONAL LINKS; CHRONOLOGY REMAINS UNEVEN

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions

NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh → long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism
- KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral → pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa → rice/date cautions
- NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

DEBATE / LEGACY

- SOUTH: Utnur, Piklihal, Tekkalakota, Hallur → cattle, millets, ash mounds
- RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

04

STAGE 04 ASH MOUNDS: FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE

ASH MOUNDS FORMATION-FUNCTION DEBATE BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND PERIODIC PEN BURNING COMMUNAL FEASTING REPEATED FIRING AND CATTLE CENTRALITY ARE STRONG; ONE EXCLUSIVE

USE UTNUR AND RELATED SITES AS A PASTORAL-LANDSCAPE PROBLEM

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice
- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.

METHOD / DEBATE

- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.
- BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT → SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND periodic pen burning communal feasting sanitation/fuel practice

HISTORICAL RESULT

- Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.
- Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

05

STAGE 05 CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES: REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX

CHALCOLITHIC CULTURES REGION-SITE-MARKER MATRIX CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS GANESHWAR-JODHPURA GANESHWAR/JODHPURA COPPER CRAFT; HARAPPAN CONTACT AHAR-BANAS AHAR, BALATHAL, GILUND BLACK-RED WARE; COPPER; FARMING

KAYATHA KAYATHA EARLY MALWA SEQUENCE; RICH DEPOSITS MALWA NAVDATOLI, ERAN, NAGDA PAINTED WARE; LARGE VILLAGES; SPREAD JORWE INAMGAON, NEVASA DECCAN HIERARCHY; LATE JORWE

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact
Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread
Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

DEBATE / LEGACY

OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CULTURE/ZONE CORE SITES HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
- Ganeshwar-Jodhpura Ganeshwar/Jodhpura copper craft; Harappan contact
- Ahar-Banas Ahar, Balathal, Gilund black-red ware; copper; farming

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Kayatha Kayatha early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
- Malwa Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda painted ware; large villages; spread
- Jorwe Inamgaon, Nevasa Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe

DEBATE / LEGACY

OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCP/Copper Hoards upper Ganga sites association varies; no ethnic label.

06

STAGE 06 CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY

CHALCOLITHIC RURAL POLITICAL ECONOMY VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS CROP/HERD PRODUCTION CRAFT WORK EXCHANGE UNEQUAL HOUSES RISK AND SURPLUS COPPER/POTTERY REGIONAL NETWORKS SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND DIFFERENTIAL BURIALS MAY INDICATE INEQUALITY.

MOST SYSTEMS WERE REGIONAL AND RURAL, NOT FAILED HARAPPAN

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk

Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks
- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.
- VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS → crop/herd production → storage → craft work → exchange unequal houses risk and surplus copper/pottery regional networks

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.
- Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

07

STAGE 07 DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS

DECLINE, TRANSFORMATION AND CULTURAL LABELS LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE ARIDITY + PRODUCTION STRESS + SETTLEMENT REORGANISATION SOME ABANDONMENT CAUTION 1 ARCHAEOLOGICAL CULTURE MATERIAL PATTERN, NOT A NAMED PEOPLE. CAUTION 2

COPPER USE DOES NOT DISPLACE STONE OR PROVE URBANISATION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies
- + local continuity

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.
- CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.
- LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

08

STAGE 08 NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

NEOLITHIC-CHALCOLITHIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE 10 MARKS DEFINE PHASE TWO REGIONAL SITES EVIDENCE CAUTION 15 MARKS TRANSITION CAUSES DOMESTICATION PROOF

10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution

15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society

ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: define phase → process → two regional sites → evidence caution
- 15 MARKS: transition causes → domestication proof → technology/settlement → comparison

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: mosaic chronology → regional map → Chalcolithic matrix → economy/society
- ash-mound debate → transformation → qualified synthesis

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.
- CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION 3. STUDY LINKS 4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS) 5. UPSC TRAPS 6. CURRENT LINK 7. MAINS ANGLES

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Optional Advanced Case Clinics: Evidence Without Overreach — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- At Koldihwa, Mahagara, Pachoh and Indari, key issues are dates and whether rice remains are wild or domesticated.
- Upinder Singh also highlights Lahuradewa as evidence that the middle Ganga valley was an early rice-cultivation zone, preventing
- a single north-west-to-east diffusion model.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.